

The Yarn Crafter's Survival Kit

Seven practical references for swatching, gauge, tools, yarn planning, and rescuing a project before an expensive mistake.

WHAT IS INSIDE

- Current yarn-weight starting ranges
- Common hook and needle conversions
- US and UK crochet terms
- Treated-swatch size prediction
- Yarn planning from your own swatch
- A fillable project-rescue record

These are planning aids, not promises. Yarn construction, stitch pattern, tension, treatment, finishing, and measurement technique can change the result.

Free for personal project planning

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Yarn weight starting ranges

Use these industry ranges to orient a project, then follow the pattern and make a treated swatch.

WEIGHT	KNIT STS/4 IN	NEEDLE MM	CROCHET/4 IN	HOOK MM
0 Lace	33-40*	1.5-2.25	32-42 dc*	steel 1.4-1.6 / regular 2.25
1 Super Fine	27-32	2.25-3.25	21-32	2.25-3.5
2 Fine	23-26	3.25-3.75	16-20	3.5-4.5
3 Light	21-24	3.75-4.5	12-17	4.5-5.5
4 Medium	16-20	4.5-5.5	11-14	5.5-6.5
5 Bulky	12-15	5.5-8	8-11	6.5-9
6 Super Bulky	7-11	8-12.75	7-9	9-15
7 Jumbo	6 or fewer	12.75+	6 or fewer	15+

* Lace gauges vary widely. The CYC lists lace crochet in double crochet rather than single crochet.

THREE RULES THAT PREVENT EXPENSIVE GUESSES

1. Treat the swatch the way the finished item will be washed, blocked, dried, and handled. 2. Buy the planned yarn together when dye-lot consistency matters. 3. Use the millimeter tool size and your measured gauge when labels, brands, and patterns disagree.

Hook and needle conversions

Letter and number labels vary. Treat the millimeter measurement as the reliable reference and recheck gauge.

CROCHET HOOKS

MM	US
2.25	B-1
2.75	C-2
3.25	D-3
3.5	E-4
3.75	F-5
4	G-6
4.5	7
5	H-8
5.5	I-9
6	J-10
6.5	K-10 1/2
8	L-11
9	M/N-13
10	N/P-15
11.5	P-16
15	P/Q
16	Q
19	S

KNITTING NEEDLES

MM	US
1.5	000
1.75	00
2	0
2.25	1
2.75	2
3.25	3
3.5	4
3.75	5
4	6
4.5	7
5	8
5.5	9
6	10
6.5	10 1/2
8	11
9	13
10	15
12.75	17

DO NOT FORCE THE CONVERSION

A conversion identifies the tool, not the resulting fabric. If the measured gauge is wrong, change the tool or material and make another swatch.

US and UK crochet terms

Confirm the terminology before starting. The same stitch name can describe a different stitch system.

THE COMMON TRAP

US double crochet is not UK double crochet. US single crochet equals UK double crochet. Check the pattern origin or its terminology note.

UNITED STATES	UNITED KINGDOM
Slip stitch (sl st)	Slip stitch (ss)
Single crochet (sc)	Double crochet (dc)
Half double crochet (hdc)	Half treble (htr)
Double crochet (dc)	Treble (tr)
Treble / triple crochet (tr)	Double treble (dtr)
Double treble (dtr)	Triple treble (trtr)
Triple treble (trtr)	Quadruple treble (qtr)
Gauge	Tension
Yarn over (yo)	Yarn over hook (yoh)
Skip (sk)	Miss (m)

READ THE SETUP NOTES

Do not infer the system from one abbreviation alone. Designers may define custom terms. Preserve the pattern's definitions, stitch multiple, turning-chain rules, and whether joins count as stitches.

Swatch-to-finish calculation

Measure the same swatch before and after the treatment planned for the finished item.

1. RECORD THE CHANGE

change rate = treated measurement / untreated measurement

Example: 4.25 in / 4.00 in = 1.0625, or about 6.25% growth

2. PREDICT A FINISHED DIMENSION

predicted treated dimension = planned untreated dimension x change rate

Example: 20 in x 1.0625 = about 21.25 in after the same treatment

3. WORK BACKWARD FROM A TARGET

needed untreated dimension = target treated dimension / change rate

Example: 20 in / 1.0625 = about 18.82 in before treatment

LIMITATIONS

A swatch is evidence, not a guarantee. Large pieces can hang differently; stitch patterns, seams, ribbing, colorwork, garment weight, wear, and treatment can change the result. Use the same yarn, tool, stitch, measurement method, and treatment, then allow a planning range.

Estimate yarn from your swatch

Use measured consumption from the planned yarn and stitch rather than a generic yards-per-square-inch claim.

STEP 1 - MEASURE

Record the treated swatch width, height, and weight. Calculate its area only when the project can reasonably be estimated by area.

$$\text{project grams} = \text{swatch grams} \times (\text{project area} / \text{swatch area})$$

Example: 8 g x (2,000 sq in / 25 sq in) = 640 g before contingency

STEP 2 - CONVERT TO SKEINS

$$\text{skeins by weight} = \text{planned grams} / \text{label grams per skein}$$

Round up only after adding a project-specific contingency.

STEP 3 - CROSS-CHECK

If the swatch has separately measured yarn length and weight, calculate both and use the more conservative whole-skein result. Keep the label and dye lot with the project record.

WHEN AREA SCALING IS WEAK

Do not use simple area scaling when shaping, dense borders, fringe, cables, texture, color changes, motif joins, varying gauges, or garment construction materially change consumption. Use a larger representative sample, the pattern designer's yardage, and a suitable contingency.

Fillable project-rescue record

Save a fresh copy for each project, or print this page and keep it with the yarn label.

PROJECT

PATTERN OR SOURCE

YARN, COLORWAY, AND DYE LOT

HOOK OR NEEDLE IN MM

PATTERN GAUGE

SWATCH BEFORE TREATMENT

SWATCH AFTER TREATMENT

TARGET FINISHED SIZE

STITCH OR REPEAT MULTIPLE

YARN PLANNED PLUS CONTINGENCY

BEFORE AN IRREVERSIBLE STEP

☐ Treated gauge rechecked

☐ Counts rechecked against target

☐ Dye lots and quantities recorded

☐ Repeat and edge stitches confirmed

☐ Care method tested on swatch

☐ Pattern notes and modifications saved

WHERE I LEFT OFF

WHAT CHANGED AND WHY

NEXT DECISION